

**UNIVERSIDAD NACIONAL DEL SUR – Programa de Idioma Inglés**  
**Curso de Lectura Comprensiva de Textos en Inglés – Nivel II**  
**1er Parcial (modelo)**

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APELLIDO Y NOMBRE: ..... FECHA:.....

CARRERA: ..... L.U.:.....

### **Antoine de Saint-Exupéry – A biography**

Antoine de Saint-Exupéry is both a pioneer of aviation and a well-known French writer. He was born in Lyon, France, on June 29, 1900. At an early age, he dreamed of a life of adventure and wanted to become a naval officer. **Unfortunately, he failed the exam to qualify him for naval officer training school. As a result, he turned his attention to the field of aviation.** Even though flying was dangerous and risky in Saint-Exupéry's time, he joined the military and trained to be a pilot.

After his military service, he presented himself to the director of an airline company and expressed his desire to become a commercial pilot. **The director told him he must first become an airplane mechanic.** Finally, in 1927, Saint-Exupéry became a pilot, opening up new air routes over the Mediterranean Sea, North Africa, and the Sahara Desert. Because of the danger of flying, he had a number of accidents, but he escaped any major injuries. Later, Saint-Exupéry became the director of his own aviation company in South America, where he often flew dangerous routes over the Andes Mountains.

For Saint-Exupéry, flying was not just piloting an airplane; it was a time for meditation and reflection. While in the air, Saint-Exupéry **would think** deeply **about solitude, friendship, the meaning of life, the human condition, and liberty.** He decided to publish his reflections into a book, **which was successful.** When his aviation company failed, Saint-Exupéry decided to pursue writing as a career. He first became a journalist, traveling to Spain, Russia, and Germany. He also wrote two philosophical books based on aviation: *Night Flight* (1932) and *Wind, Sand, and Stars* (1939). Still in love with piloting an airplane, Saint-Exupéry continued to fly whenever he had the opportunity.

In 1939, when France went to war with Germany, Saint-Exupéry immediately enlisted in the army, hoping to become a military pilot in the war effort. France, however, was soon defeated and occupied by Hitler's troops. **Saint-Exupéry decided to leave his homeland, settle in the United States, and pursue his writing career.** It was in New York that he published *The Little Prince*, which was his most celebrated book, in 1943. Since its first publication, more than 25 million copies **have been sold** in 75 different countries.

In 1942, the year **when American troops landed in North Africa,** Saint-Exupéry decided to join the U.S. army as a pilot. **Since he was 42 years of age, he was initially considered too old to be a pilot and was not allowed to fly;** however, Saint-Exupéry persisted and was finally given an airplane. He accomplished many missions over occupied France. On July 31, 1944, Saint-Exupéry left for his last mission. His plane **was destroyed** by the Germans over the Mediterranean.



1. Leer rápidamente el texto completo e **indicar el orden** en el que aparecen las siguientes informaciones:

---2--- a. Como piloto comercial, Saint-Exupéry sobrevivió a varios accidentes.

---4--- b. Se publicó su libro más famoso.

---1--- c. Saint-Exupéry deseaba ser oficial de la marina.

---5--- d. Logró que lo aceptaran como piloto de guerra.

---3--- e. Saint-Exupéry comenzó su carrera como escritor.

**2. Responder en español las siguientes preguntas:**

- a. When did Saint-Exupéry become interested in aviation?

Cuando desaprobó el examen para ingresar a la escuela naval.

- b. What job did he have before becoming a commercial pilot?

Fue mecánico de aviones.

- c. What were his books about?

Sus libros trataban sobre la soledad, la amistad, el sentido de la vida, la condición humana y la libertad.

- d. What did Saint-Exupéry do when Germany occupied France?

Decidió abandonar su patria, se instaló en EE.UU. y dedicarse a su carrera de escritor.

- e. Why was it difficult for him to join the US army?

Porque como tenía 42 años, al principio se lo consideró demasiado mayor para ser piloto y no se le permitió volar.

3. Marcar **tres (3) oraciones subordinadas** con distinto pronombre relativo en el texto. Indicar el principio y el fin con paréntesis y **expresarlas en español**:

1. que fue exitoso / que tuvo éxito / que fue un éxito
2. que fue su libro más célebre/ celebrado / famoso
3. (el año) en que las tropas estadounidenses aterrizaron en el norte de África
4. En el texto aparecen los siguientes **verbos**. Indicar con una cruz (x) si se encuentran en **voz activa o pasiva** y proponer una versión en español:

| Frase Verbal               | Línea | Voz Activa | Voz Pasiva | Traducción                         |
|----------------------------|-------|------------|------------|------------------------------------|
| <b>failed</b>              | 3     | X          |            | desaprobó                          |
| <b>must (first) become</b> | 8-9   | X          |            | debía (primero) convertirse en     |
| <b>would think</b>         | 15    | X          |            | pensaría / pensaba                 |
| <b>have been sold</b>      | 29    |            | X          | han sido vendidas / se han vendido |
| <b>was destroyed</b>       | 36    |            | X          | fue destruido                      |

5. Buscar las **frases subrayadas** y expresarlas **en español** de acuerdo al contexto en el que aparecen:
  - a. Aunque volar era peligroso y arriesgado en la época de Saint-Exupéry
  - b. se presentó al director de una compañía aérea y le expresó su deseo de convertirse en piloto comercial
  - c. volar no era solamente pilotear un avión
  - d. siguió/ continuó volando siempre que tuvo la oportunidad
  - e. Fue en Nueva York donde publicó El Principito